



reflect the trust that national and international sports federations have begun placing in Bihar's capabilities. Chief Minister Nitish Kumar has made it clear that KIYG 2025 is not the end but rather the beginning of a new chapter in the state's sports development journey.

While athletes from across India dazzled spectators, Bihar's own young sports stars began to emerge in the spotlight. The host state earned 36 medals, including several in disciplines like rugby, athletics, and traditional martial arts. This marked a substantial improvement from previous editions and

validated the investments made in training, nutrition, and coaching. The story of Samuel Zadeng, a boxer from Mizoram who won his state's first KIYG gold medal in Patna, added to the emotional texture of the Games. For many young athletes like him, Bihar became the place where dreams met opportunity — fuelled by a government that chose to invest in hope.

A promising future

Nitish Kumar's leadership throughout this entire journey has been marked by a quiet determination and results-driven

Star-studded: The opening ceremony of KIYG 2025 was held at the Patliputra Sports Complex in Patna, which featured a special video address by Prime Minister Narendra Modi, who acknowledged Bihar's rapid transformation into a sporting hub and praised the efforts taken by the state government.

action. Unlike the flamboyant public relations campaigns seen in other parts of the country, Bihar's transformation has been more grounded and sustainable. By empowering local sports officers, involving district administrations, and directly overseeing the planning stages, Kumar ensured accountability at every level. His government's partnership with central agencies, sports federations, and private stakeholders like the Simply Sport Foundation demonstrated his belief in collaboration over politics.

The CM also ensured that sports were viewed not just as a competitive endeavour but as a public good. His vision of sports includes youth empowerment, community building, and even tourism.

KIYG 2025 served as a blueprint for how states can harness sports for economic growth, urban development, and public health. With hotels, restaurants, and transport sectors all benefiting from the Games, the local economy received a much-needed boost, especially in tier-2 cities like Bhagalpur and Begusarai.

Bihar's Sporting Renaissance

As the curtain falls on the 2025 edition of the Khelo India Youth Games, Bihar's narrative has changed irrevocably. Once



Local flavour: While athletes from across India dazzled spectators, Bihar's own young sports stars began to emerge in the spotlight.